

Descriptive Essay

Course: ENG 7102
Lecturer: Hridvika Paul





What is a descriptive essay?

A descriptive essay is an essay that describes something – an object or person, an event or place, an experience or emotion, or an idea. The goal of this kind of essay is to provide readers with enough detailed descriptions for them to be able to picture or imagine the chosen topic.



Types of descriptive essay

1. Formal/Concrete essay type (describing something that makes appeal to your senses)
2. Personal descriptive essay (describing a place/person/object/experience)



Steps of writing a descriptive essay

i. Select a subject

Observation is the key to writing a good description. For example, if you are writing about a place, go there and take notes on the sights, sounds, and smells. A descriptive essay paints a picture for the reader, using descriptive devices and the senses.

ii. Select dominant details

Select only the details that support the dominant impression (your thesis statement). Create a thesis statement that informs the reader who or what you are describing. Examples: “The white, sandy beach of Cox’s Bazar is a sight to behold.” “My favourite teacher helped me overcome my fear of learning English.”



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iii. Organize details

The paragraphs in a descriptive essay can be structured spatially (from top to bottom or from near to far) or chronologically (time order) or from general to specific. Descriptive essays can also use other patterns of organization such as narrative or exemplification.

iv. Use descriptive words

Do not use vague words or generalities (such as good, nice, bad, or beautiful). Be specific and use sensory, descriptive words (adjectives). For example: I had a great snack. ORI devoured a plate of hot, spicy and crunchy fuchka for a snack.



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v. Draw a logical conclusion

The conclusion may also use descriptive words; however, make certain the conclusion is logical and relevant.



Structure

1. **Thesis statement** (write 3 dominant features related to the topic to be described)
2. **Supporting detail 1**
 - a) **Topic sentence** (on the first dominant idea)
 - b) **Supporting points** (explain in terms of how it created significant effects on you/results, its appearance, reasons behind it- keeping in line with the point talked about in the topic sentence. Write 2 points)



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3. Supporting detail 2

- a) Topic sentence** (on the second dominant idea)
- b) Supporting points** (same as before)

4. Supporting detail 3

- a) Topic sentence** (on the third dominant idea)
- b) Supporting points** (same as before)



Important Transitional Words

Firstly, To begin with, secondly, thirdly/finally, again, also, and, then, Besides, further(more), in addition to, as, for example, for instance, thus, to illustrate, such as, in brief, in summary, to summarize, in a nutshell, in conclusion, to conclude, to sum up





THANK YOU!